

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: 2015 Cabinet resolution, executive status and Planning Commission transition

ROOT PROBLEM

How can national development strategy coordinate Union, States and local needs without reviving central command planning?

1 JANUARY 2015 CABINET RESOLUTION

creates National Institution for Transforming India, NITI Aayog.

LEGAL STATUS

executive | non-constitutional | non-statutory | recommendation-based.

TRANSITION

Planning Commission model -> NITI policy platform.

Five-Year Plans ended; plan/non-plan budget classification ended through later budget reform.

CONTINUITY

both institutions arose through Union executive resolutions.

LIMIT

replacement did not transfer Article 280, budget, legislative or taxing powers to NITI.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Foundational objectives, principles and the Team India-knowledge dual role

TEAM INDIA ROLE

shared national vision with active State participation
-> cooperative federal dialogue -> policy coordination.

KNOWLEDGE AND INNOVATION ROLE

long-term strategy | best practice | research | technology
| capacity support | monitoring and feedback.

FOUNDATIONAL PRINCIPLES

bottom-up planning | inclusion of vulnerable sections
| village-to-national aggregation | partnership | outcome orientation.

POLICY CHAIN

diagnose problem -> consult -> design option -> advise competent government
-> implement through law, budget and administration -> evaluate -> revise.

LIMIT

an official objective describes mandate; it does not prove achievement or create coercive power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Composition: political leadership, expert capacity and notification-sensitive categories

CHAIRPERSON

Prime Minister.

FEDERAL FORUM

Governing Council includes Chief Ministers and relevant Union Territory leadership.

EXECUTIVE-EXPERT SIDE

Vice-Chairperson | full-time members | part-time members from institutions
| ex-officio Union Ministers | special invitees | CEO.

FOUNDATIONAL LIMITS

part-time members: maximum two | ex-officio members: maximum four.

NOTIFICATION CONTROL

names, portfolios, invitees and exact composition may be reconstituted.
Use the current official notification only when a dated fact is required.

TRAP

CEO or Vice-Chairperson status is executive design, not constitutional tenure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Governing Council, Regional Councils and cooperative federal process

GOVERNING COUNCIL

continuing development-policy forum chaired by Prime Minister
-> State and Union Territory leaders deliberate on shared priorities.

REGIONAL COUNCILS

temporary issue-specific groups for more than one State or a region
-> chaired or convened under the resolution's executive design.

COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM

consultation + agenda sharing + joint diagnosis + peer learning + follow-up.

STATE SUPPORT

State Support Mission and State Institutions for Transformation
offer capacity and policy-system assistance; uptake varies.

BOTTOM-UP CLAIM

village plans should aggregate upward, but local planning depends on State law and capacity.

LIMIT

Council consensus is political coordination, not a second chamber or binding intergovernmental law.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Competitive federalism, dashboards and the evidence-to-action mechanism

COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM

common indicators -> comparable performance -> public ranking or delta
-> peer pressure -> administrative attention -> corrective action.

DATA-TO-POLICY LOOP

define outcome -> select indicator -> establish baseline -> collect and verify
-> compare -> diagnose cause -> intervene -> reassess.

POTENTIAL GAIN

visibility, learning, priority focus and faster feedback without command power.

RISKS

Goodhart's law | gaming | data lag | unequal capacity
| composite-index opacity | correlation mistaken for causation.

SAFE USE

publish method and uncertainty; pair rank with levels, change and field evidence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Aspirational initiatives, SDG localisation, DME0 and innovation within bounds

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS / BLOCKS

convergence + collaboration + competition

-> indicator tracking and delta improvement

-> implementation remains with governments and field agencies.

SDG LOCALISATION

national goals -> indicator framework -> State and local comparison

-> policy attention; index publication is not constitutional power.

DME0

monitoring and evaluation support -> evidence on design, process and outcomes.

ATAL INNOVATION MISSION

executive programme under NITI; current architecture depends on Cabinet and programme controls.

BOUNDARY

NITI may coordinate, study, rank and recommend.

It does not legislate, appropriate money or guarantee district outcomes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: NITI, Planning Commission, Finance Commission and GST Council compared

NITI AAYOG

2015 executive resolution | strategy, dialogue, knowledge and monitoring | no transfer award.

PLANNING COMMISSION

1950 executive resolution | Five-Year Plans and plan-resource influence | abolished.

FINANCE COMMISSION

Article 280 | periodic expert recommendations on tax distribution and grants.

GST COUNCIL

Article 279A | continuing Union-State forum for GST recommendations.

INTER-STATE COUNCIL

Article 263 route | intergovernmental coordination and advice.

STATE FINANCE COMMISSION

Articles 243I and 243Y | State-local fiscal recommendations.

TRAP

strategy, fiscal distribution, tax coordination and intergovernmental consultation are distinct.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Strengths, accountability deficits, reform and the dated federal anchor

STRENGTHS

flexibility | high-level convening | cross-sector knowledge
| State dialogue | rapid policy studies | monitoring and innovation.

LIMITS

non-binding advice | central agenda power | weak legislative reporting
| data quality | uncertain follow-through | capacity asymmetry.

REFORM

publish consultation records and evaluation methods
-> independent data audit -> State agenda windows
-> action-taken tracking -> parliamentary scrutiny without statutory rigidity.

DATED ANCHOR

11th Governing Council, 11 June 2026:
"Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat@2047."

CAUTION

meeting theme proves agenda and convening, not implementation success or a justiciable target.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: PYQ routes, close-option traps and qualified policy-platform synthesis

PYQ ROUTES

2018 GS-III -> principles of NITI versus Planning Commission.

2019 Prelims -> Atal Innovation Mission institutional location.

PRELIMS FIREWALL

executive != unconstitutional | no Article 280 allocation

| Governing Council != legislature | Regional Council != Zonal Council

| index != binding power | plan/non-plan abolition != NITI decree.

MAINS SPINE

2015 origin -> legal status -> objectives -> composition

-> federal mechanism -> evidence tools -> comparison

-> strength and deficit -> accountable reform.

QUALIFIED VERDICT

NITI is influential when credible evidence, State ownership and competent implementation converge;

without them, soft coordination cannot substitute for law, finance or administrative capacity.